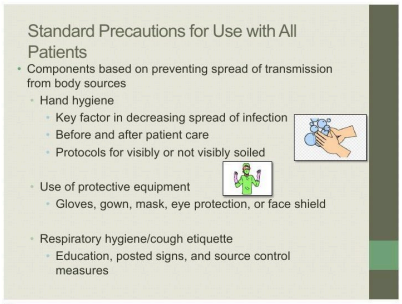
# Head-to-Toe Check-off: Beginner Step-by-Step Guide (v3.1)

**NRSG 233 Health Assessment, LLU, Fall 2026.** This is a personal practice guide, not an assignment. It follows her **Head to Toe Skills Performance Rubric (63 pts)** exactly, in rubric order. Everything here is graded, and nothing else is included.

**The rules (syllabus + rubric):** Check-off in Week 9 (Nov 16–27), on a partner, recorded. **15-minute limit. No prompting:** −1 pt each time. You need **76%** to pass the course (a retake caps at 80%).
**How each assessment is scored (1.5 pts): 0.25** for saying the NAME of the assessment out loud, **0.75** for the correct TECHNIQUE, **0.5** for stating FINDINGS in medical terms. So for every item: **1) Say what you're doing, 2) do it right, 3) say the normal finding out loud.**
**Points:** Introduction/Safety 6 × 0.25 = 1.5. Assessments 41 × 1.5 = 61.5. **Total 63.** +1 bonus for the pulse grading scale.
**Technique words:** INSPECT = look (and listen) carefully. PALPATE = feel with your fingers or hand. PERCUSS = tap to hear the tone. AUSCULTATE = listen with the stethoscope on bare skin.
**Sources:** her slides first (Module 1, Mental Status, Module 2 HEENT, Module 3 Skin, Module 4 Abdomen & MS). Jarvis 9e page numbers come from her doc sheets and the rubric's note to "refer to Jarvis." Photos labeled Jarvis are textbook photos. The two diagrams were drawn for this guide.

## Introduction / Safety (6 × 0.25 = 1.5 pts)

Do these the moment you start, in this order.



Her Module 1 slides: Standard Precautions

### Washed Hands — 0.25

**How:** Walk in, go straight to the sink or foam dispenser. Rub all surfaces for at least 20 sec, then let it dry. Do it where the instructor can see.

**Say:** (Say it out loud): "I'm performing hand hygiene."

**Common mistake:** Starting to talk or touch the partner first. Doing it off-camera.


Jarvis p. 770

### Introduced Self — 0.25

**How:** Face the partner at eye level and make eye contact.

**Say:** "Hi, my name is Luke. I'm a nursing student, and I'll be doing your physical assessment today."

**Common mistake:** Forgetting your role ("nursing student").


Jarvis p. 770

### Identified Patient with 2 Identifiers — 0.25

**How:** Ask open questions. Don't say their name for them. Check against the armband or chart.

**Say:** "Can you please tell me your full name and date of birth?"

**Common mistake:** Asking "Are you John?" (that's a yes/no question). Using only one identifier.



Jarvis p. 770

### Verified Allergy Status — 0.25

**How:** Ask, then confirm with the armband or chart.

**Say:** "Do you have any allergies to medications, foods, or latex?"

**Common mistake:** Skipping it. It's an easy 0.25.



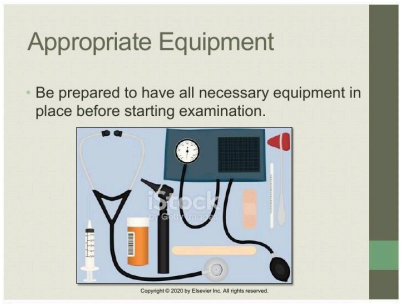
Jarvis p. 770

### Explained Assessment to Patient — 0.25

**How:** Short and simple. Say they can stop you at any time.

**Say:** "I'm going to do a head-to-toe assessment. I'll look, listen, and feel from your head to your toes. It takes about 15 minutes. Let me know if anything is uncomfortable. Is that okay?"

**Common mistake:** Not asking for permission.




Her Module 1 slides: Appropriate Equipment

### Cleaned Stethoscope — 0.25

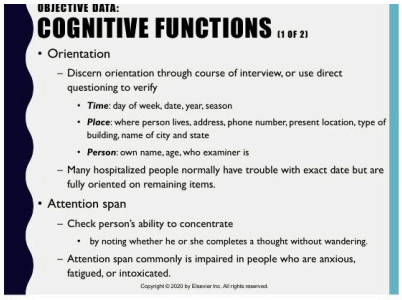
**How:** Wipe the diaphragm, bell, and earpieces with an alcohol pad before you use it. Let it dry.

**Say:** "I'm cleaning my stethoscope with an alcohol wipe."

**Common mistake:** Cleaning it silently. Say it so it gets graded.

## Mental Status (3 × 1.5 = 4.5 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT (watch and listen, no touching)
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits on the bed. You sit or stand facing them at eye level.




Her Mental Status slides: Cognitive functions

### 1. Orientation (3 assessments) — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm assessing orientation to person, place, and time."
② **Do it (0.75):** Ask 3 questions, one each for person, place, and time. Listen to whether the answers are correct and quick.

**Say to partner:** "What is your name? Where are we right now? What is today's date?"

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Patient is alert and oriented ×3 to person, place, and time." (A&O×3)

**Common mistake:** Asking only 2 questions, or saying "A&O" without the ×3.

[Her slides; Jarvis pp. 63, 67]




Her Mental Status slides: Cultural assessment

### 2. Culture (1 assessment) — 1.5

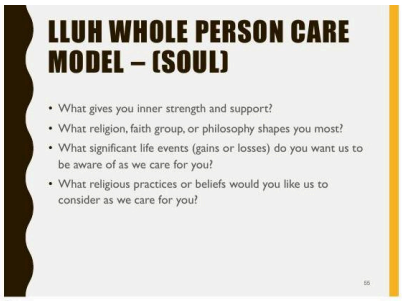
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm doing a cultural assessment."
② **Do it (0.75):** Ask one open-ended question about cultural background or health practices.

**Say to partner:** "Is there anything about your culture or background I should know to care for you?"

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Patient identifies as ___. No cultural practices affecting care." (State what they say.)

**Common mistake:** Assuming their culture. Always ask.

[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis pp. 16–17]



Her slides: LLUH Whole Person Care (SOUL)

### 3. Spiritual (1 assessment) — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm doing a spiritual assessment."
② **Do it (0.75):** Ask one SOUL question (Sources of strength, Organized religion, Unique life events, Life practices).

**Say to partner:** "What gives you inner strength and support?"

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Patient states ___ is a source of strength. No spiritual needs at this time."

**Common mistake:** Pushing your own beliefs or asking a yes/no question.

[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 17]

## Head (1 × 1.5 = 1.5 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT & PALPATE
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. Stand in front of them.


Jarvis p. 771 (photo)

### 4. Skull (size & symmetry) — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting and palpating the skull for size and symmetry."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at the head from the front and sides. Then use the pads of your fingers to move the scalp in small circles, front to back, feeling for lumps or tenderness.

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to feel your head. Tell me if anything is tender."

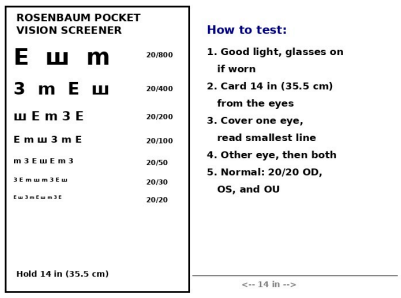
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Skull is normocephalic and symmetric. No lumps, lesions, or tenderness."

**Common mistake:** Only looking (you must also palpate), or forgetting the word "normocephalic."

[Jarvis p. 259; Module 2 slides]

## Eyes (5 × 1.5 = 7.5 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. You stand in front. For acuity, they hold the Rosenbaum pocket card 14 inches (35.5 cm) from their eyes.



Rosenbaum near-vision pocket card (drawn diagram)

### 5. Visual Acuity — 1.5

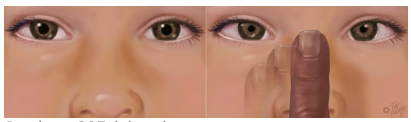
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing visual acuity with the Rosenbaum chart."
② **Do it (0.75):** In good light, partner holds the Rosenbaum near-vision card 14 inches (35.5 cm) from the eyes, glasses on if they wear them. Have them cover one eye and read the smallest line they can. Repeat with the other eye, then with both eyes.

**Say to partner:** "Hold this card about 14 inches from your eyes. Cover your left eye and read the smallest line you can."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Visual acuity 20/20 OS, OD, and OU by Rosenbaum chart, no squinting."

**Common mistake:** Partner pressing on the covered eye. Forgetting to test each eye separately and then both together. Holding the card too close or too far.

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis pp. 289–290]


Jarvis p. 295 (photo)

### 6. Pupil Size & Shape — 1.5

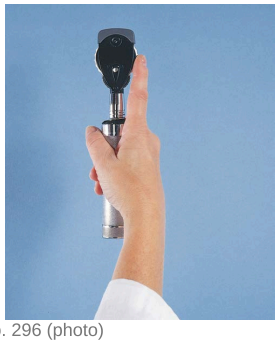
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting pupil size and shape."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at both pupils in normal room light and compare them.

**Say to partner:** "Look straight ahead at the wall."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Pupils are equal, round, about 3–5 mm."

**Common mistake:** Not comparing the two sides.

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 295]



Jarvis p. 296 (photo)

### 7. Direct Light Reflex

1.5

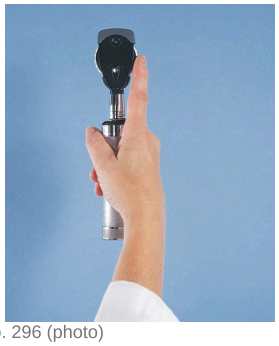
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing the direct light reflex."
② **Do it (0.75):** Dim the light if you can. Bring the penlight in from the side (not straight on) into one eye. Watch the SAME pupil constrict. Do both eyes.

**Say to partner:** "Keep looking at the wall. I'm going to shine a light in your eye."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Direct light reflex present, brisk constriction bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Shining it straight on, which makes them focus on the light.

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 295]



Jarvis p. 296 (photo)

### 8. Consensual Light Reflex

1.5

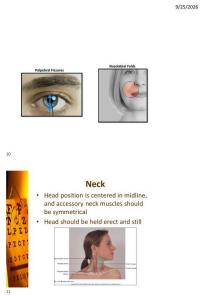
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing the consensual light reflex."
② **Do it (0.75):** Shine the light into one eye and watch the OPPOSITE pupil. It should constrict too. Do both sides.

**Say to partner:** "Keep looking ahead."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Consensual light reflex present bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Watching the wrong eye.

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 295]




Her Module 2 HEENT slides (eyes)

### 9. Accommodation

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing accommodation."
② **Do it (0.75):** Have them look at the far wall, then quickly at your finger held about 7–8 cm from their nose. The pupils should constrict and the eyes converge.

**Say to partner:** "Look at the wall... now look at my finger."

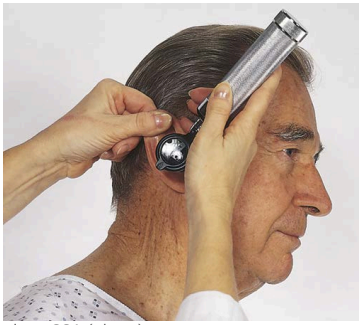
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Accommodation present: pupils constrict and eyes converge. PERRLA."

**Common mistake:** Holding your finger too far away.

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 295]

## Ears (2 × 1.5 = 3 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT; INSPECT & PALPATE
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. Stand at their side.



Jarvis p. 331 (photo)

### 10. External Auditory Meatus

1.5

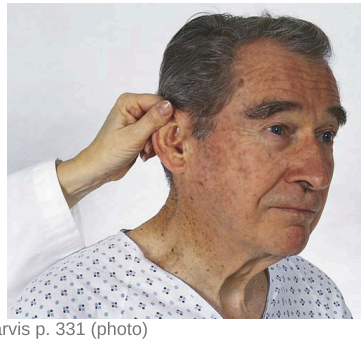
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the external auditory meatus."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look into the ear opening with a penlight or otoscope. In adults, gently pull the auricle up and back.

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to look inside your ear."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Meatus is patent, no discharge, redness, or swelling. Small amount of cerumen."

**Common mistake:** Pulling the ear down (that's for children).

[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 331]


Jarvis p. 331 (photo)

### 11. External Ear

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting and palpating the external ear."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at the size, shape, and skin. Move the auricle and press the tragus.
**Say to partner:** "Tell me if this hurts."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Auricles symmetric, skin intact, no lesions. Nontender to palpation."
**Common mistake:** Only looking (you must also palpate).
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 331]

## Nose (2 × 1.5 = 3 pts)

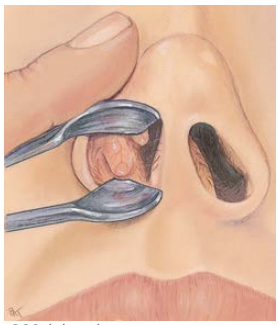
**Technique:** INSPECT & PALPATE; INSPECT
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. Stand in front.


Jarvis p. 360 (photo)

### 12. External Nose

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting and palpating the external nose."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look for symmetry, deformity, and lesions. Gently palpate down the bridge.
**Say to partner:** "I'm going to gently feel your nose."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Nose is symmetric and midline. No deformity, lesions, or tenderness."
**Common mistake:** Skipping the palpation.
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 360]


Jarvis p. 360 (photo)

### 13. Patency of Nostrils

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing patency of the nostrils."
② **Do it (0.75):** Press one nostril closed with your finger. Have them close their mouth and sniff. Then do the other side.
**Say to partner:** "Close your mouth and sniff in through your nose."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Both nares are patent."
**Common mistake:** Closing both sides at once.
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 360]

## Mouth (4 × 1.5 = 6 pts)

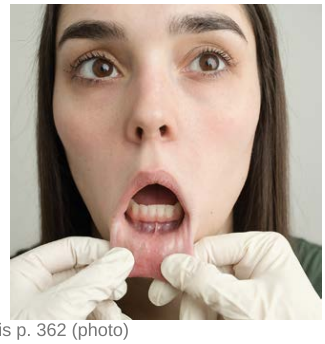
**Technique:** INSPECT
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. Use a penlight and tongue blade. Put on gloves.


Jarvis p. 362 (photo)

### 14. Lips

1.5

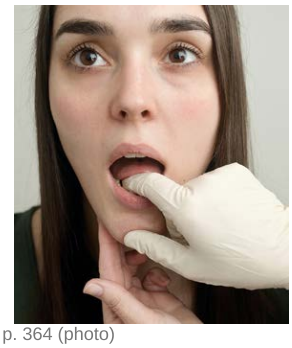
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the lips."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at the color, moisture, and any cracks or lesions.
**Say to partner:** "Relax your lips for me."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Lips are pink, moist, smooth, and symmetric. No lesions."
**Common mistake:** Forgetting to say the color.
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 362]


Jarvis p. 362 (photo)

### 15. Gums

1.5

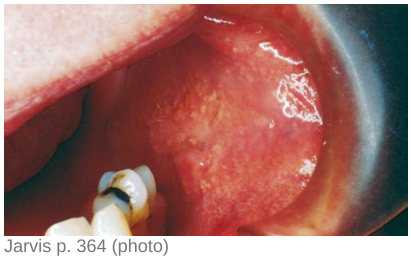
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the gums."
② **Do it (0.75):** Use the tongue blade to move the lips and cheeks aside. Shine the light.
**Say to partner:** "Open your mouth for me."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Gums pink, moist, firm, no swelling or bleeding."
**Common mistake:** Doing it without gloves or light.
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 364]


Jarvis p. 364 (photo)

### 16. Teeth

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the teeth."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look for missing, loose, or decayed teeth.
**Say to partner:** "Show me your teeth."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Teeth are white, smooth, and aligned. No caries or missing teeth."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 364]


Jarvis p. 364 (photo)

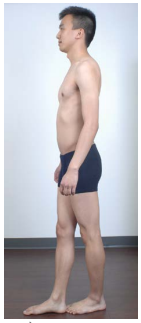
### 17. Tongue

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the tongue."
② **Do it (0.75):** Have them stick out their tongue. Look at the top, then the underside.
**Say to partner:** "Stick out your tongue... now touch the roof of your mouth."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Tongue pink, moist, midline. No lesions."
**Common mistake:** Forgetting the underside.
[Her Module 2 slides; Jarvis p. 364]

## Motor System (2 × 1.5 = 3 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT (gait); PALPATE (grip)
**Position / where you stand:** Gait: partner stands and walks. Grip: partner sits, and you stand in front.


Jarvis p. 647 (photo)

### 18. Gait

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting gait."
② **Do it (0.75):** Have them walk across the room, turn, and walk back. Stay close for safety. Watch their posture, balance, arm swing, and stride.
**Say to partner:** "Please walk to the door, turn around, and come back. I'll stay right beside you."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Gait is steady and coordinated, with even stride and arm swing."
**Common mistake:** Not staying close for safety.
[Jarvis pp. 646–647]


Jarvis p. 592 (photo)

### 19. Grip

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating grip strength."
② **Do it (0.75):** Put your index and middle fingers in each of their hands. Have them squeeze both hands at the same time and compare.
**Say to partner:** "Squeeze my fingers as hard as you can."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Grip strength strong and equal bilaterally, 5/5."
**Common mistake:** Offering your whole hand (it can hurt). Not comparing sides.
[Her Module 4 slides (strength 0–5); Jarvis p. 592]

## Sensory System (2 × 1.5 = 3 pts)

**Technique:** INSPECT
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits with eyes CLOSED. Test both sides in matching spots (hands, feet).


Jarvis p. 649 (photo)

### 20. Light Touch — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing light touch sensation."
② **Do it (0.75):** Lightly touch the skin with a cotton wisp in random spots on both sides.
**Say to partner:** "Close your eyes. Say 'now' every time you feel me touch you."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Light touch sensation intact bilaterally."
**Common mistake:** Letting them watch. Using a predictable rhythm.
[Jarvis pp. 649–651]

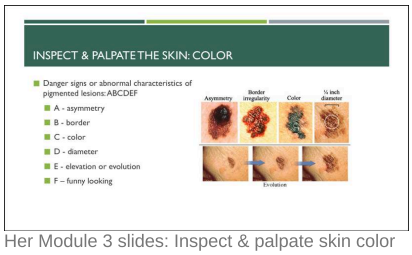

Jarvis p. 649 (photo)

### 21. Pain — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm testing superficial pain (sharp/dull)."
② **Do it (0.75):** Use a broken tongue blade, alternating the sharp and dull ends, in random order on both sides.
**Say to partner:** "Eyes closed. Tell me 'sharp' or 'dull.'"
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Able to distinguish sharp and dull bilaterally."
**Common mistake:** Pressing too hard. Not mixing the order.
[Jarvis pp. 649–651]

## Skin (4 × 1.5 = 6 pts)

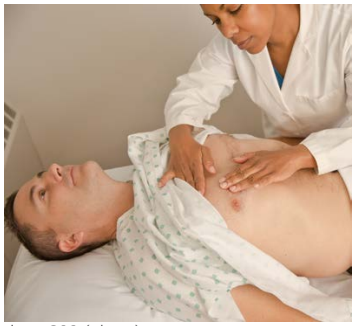
**Technique:** INSPECT (color); PALPATE (temp, edema, moisture)
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits. Use their hands, arms, and shins.



Her Module 3 slides: Inspect & palpate skin color

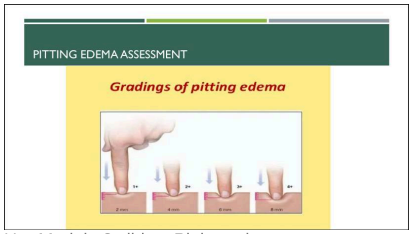
### 22. Color — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting skin color."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at the face, arms, hands, and nail beds in good light.
**Say to partner:** "Let me look at your arms and hands."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Skin color consistent with ethnicity, even pigmentation. No pallor, cyanosis, or jaundice."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 207]


Jarvis p. 209 (photo)

### 23. Temperature — 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating skin temperature."
② **Do it (0.75):** Use the BACK of your hand (it's most sensitive to temperature) on their arms and legs, comparing both sides.
**Say to partner:** "I'm going to feel your skin with the back of my hand."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Skin warm to touch bilaterally."
**Common mistake:** Using your fingertips.
[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis pp. 209–210]

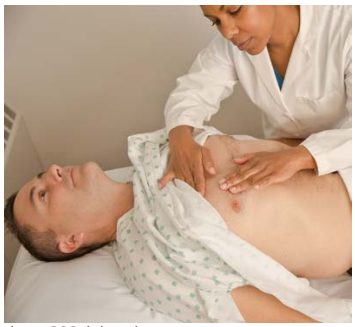


Her Module 3 slides: Pitting edema

### 24. Edema

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating for edema."
② **Do it (0.75):** Press firmly with your thumb over the shin (tibia) or the top of the foot for 5 seconds, release, and look for a dent.
**Say to partner:** "I'm going to press on your shin for a few seconds."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "No edema. Nonpitting." (If present, grade it 1+ to 4+.)
**Common mistake:** Pressing for only 1 second.
[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis pp. 210, 519]


Jarvis p. 209 (photo)

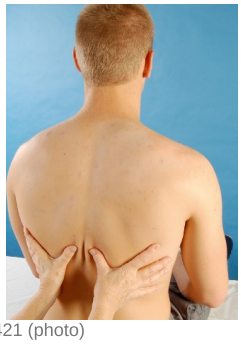
### 25. Moisture

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating skin moisture."
② **Do it (0.75):** Feel the skin surface with your fingertips.
**Say to partner:** N/A
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Skin dry and intact."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 210]

## Thorax & Lungs (Posterior Chest) (2 × 1.5 = 3 pts)

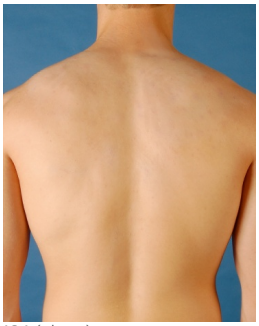
**Technique:** INSPECT; AUSCULTATE
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits and leans slightly forward with arms crossed. Open the back of the gown. Stand behind them.


Jarvis p. 421 (photo)

### 26. Chest (shape & configuration)

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting the posterior chest for shape and configuration."
② **Do it (0.75):** Look at the spine, shoulders, scapulae, and symmetry. Estimate the AP:transverse diameter.
**Say to partner:** "Please cross your arms and lean forward slightly."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Chest symmetric, AP to transverse diameter 1:2, spine midline, no deformity."
**Common mistake:** Forgetting "1:2."
[Jarvis p. 421]


Jarvis p. 424 (photo)

### 27. Chest (breath sounds)

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating posterior breath sounds."
② **Do it (0.75):** Put the stethoscope diaphragm firmly on bare skin, between the ribs and away from the scapulae. Go side to side like a ladder, top to bottom (about 6 pairs), one full breath at each spot.
**Say to partner:** "Breathe in and out through your mouth, a little deeper than normal."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "Breath sounds clear bilaterally, vesicular in the bases. No adventitious sounds (no crackles or wheezes)."
**Common mistake:** Listening over the gown or over bone. Doing one whole side, then the other.
[Jarvis pp. 424–427]

## Peripheral Vascular System (5 × 1.5 = 7.5 pts)

**Technique:** PALPATE; INSPECT & PALPATE
**Position / where you stand:** Partner sits for the carotid and radial pulses, then lies supine for the foot pulses.


Jarvis p. 471 (photo)

## 28. Carotid Pulses

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating the carotid pulses."
② **Do it (0.75):** Put 2 fingers just beside the trachea, below the jaw. Do **ONE SIDE AT A TIME**.

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to feel the pulse in your neck."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Carotid pulses 2+, equal bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Pressing both sides at once (it can cause fainting). Using your thumb.

[Jarvis p. 471]


Jarvis p. 513 (photo)

## 29. Radial Pulses

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating the radial pulses."
② **Do it (0.75):** Put 2–3 finger pads on the thumb side of the inner wrist. Compare both sides.

**Say to partner:** "Relax your arms."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Radial pulses 2+, regular, equal bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Using your thumb.

[Jarvis p. 513]


Jarvis p. 519 (photo)

## 30. Dorsalis Pedis Pulses

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating the dorsalis pedis pulses."
② **Do it (0.75):** Feel on the top of the foot, just lateral to the big-toe tendon. Press lightly.

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to feel the pulse on top of your foot."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Dorsalis pedis pulses 2+, equal bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Pressing too hard, which blocks the pulse.

[Jarvis p. 519]


Jarvis p. 519 (photo)

## 31. Posterior Tibial Pulses

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm palpating the posterior tibial pulses."
② **Do it (0.75):** Curl your fingers behind and just below the inner ankle bone (medial malleolus).

**Say to partner:** N/A

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Posterior tibial pulses 2+, equal bilaterally."

**Common mistake:** Feeling on the outer ankle.

[Jarvis p. 519]


Jarvis p. 215 (photo)

## 32. Capillary Refill

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting and palpating capillary refill."
② **Do it (0.75):** Press a fingernail until it blanches (turns white), release, and count how long the pink takes to return. Do both hands.

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to squeeze your fingernail."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Capillary refill less than 2 seconds bilaterally."

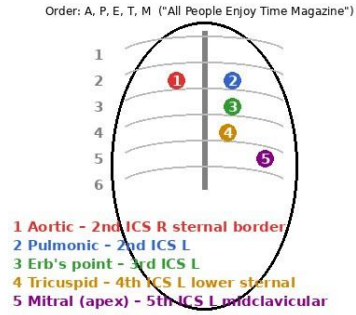
**Common mistake:** Not counting out loud.

[Her Module 3 slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 215]

★ **BONUS +1 pt: Pulse Grading Scale** [Jarvis p. 513]. Define each grade out loud: **0 = absent**; **1+ = weak / thready**; **2+ = normal**; **3+ = increased / full, bounding**. Say your pulses as "2+" so the grading is obvious.

## Heart (5 × 1.5 = 7.5 pts)

**Technique:** AUSCULTATE
**Position / where you stand:** Partner supine with the head raised about 30° (or sitting). Stand on their RIGHT. Diaphragm on bare skin. Use the diagram: **APETM**.

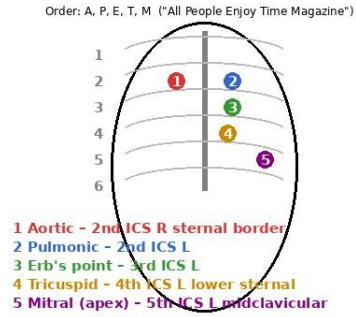


Drawn diagram (sites per Jarvis p. 475)

### 33. Aortic Area

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating the aortic area."
② **Do it (0.75):** Point 1: 2nd intercostal space, RIGHT sternal border. Find the angle of Louis (the bump on the sternum), slide right into the 2nd ICS.
**Say to partner:** "Breathe normally. I'm going to listen to your heart."
③ **State findings (0.5):** "S1 and S2 heard, regular rate and rhythm, S2 louder at the base. No murmurs."
**Common mistake:** Starting on the left side.
[Jarvis p. 475]

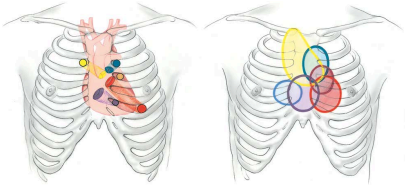


Drawn diagram

### 34. Pulmonic Area

1.5

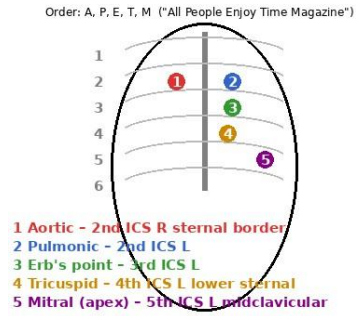
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating the pulmonic area."
② **Do it (0.75):** Point 2: 2nd ICS, LEFT sternal border.
**Say to partner:** N/A
③ **State findings (0.5):** "S1 and S2 heard, regular. No murmurs."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Jarvis p. 475]


Jarvis p. 475 (figure)

### 35. Erb's Point

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating Erb's point."
② **Do it (0.75):** Point 3: 3rd ICS, LEFT sternal border.
**Say to partner:** N/A
③ **State findings (0.5):** "S1 and S2 heard, regular. No murmurs."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Jarvis p. 475]

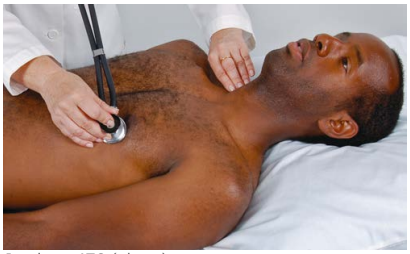


Drawn diagram

### 36. Tricuspid Area

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating the tricuspid area."
② **Do it (0.75):** Point 4: 4th ICS, LEFT lower sternal border.
**Say to partner:** N/A
③ **State findings (0.5):** "S1 and S2 heard, regular. No murmurs."
**Common mistake:** N/A
[Jarvis p. 475]


Jarvis p. 476 (photo)

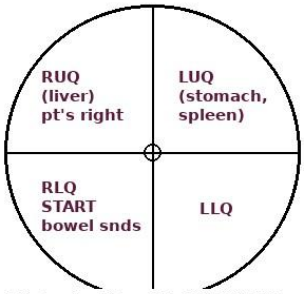
### 37. Mitral Area

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating the mitral area (apex)."
② **Do it (0.75):** Point 5: 5th ICS, LEFT midclavicular line (the apex). For women, ask them to lift the breast slightly.
**Say to partner:** N/A
③ **State findings (0.5):** "S1 and S2 heard, regular rate and rhythm, S1 louder at the apex. No murmurs, gallops, or rubs."
**Common mistake:** Listening too close to the sternum.
[Jarvis p. 475]

# Abdomen (4 × 1.5 = 6 pts)

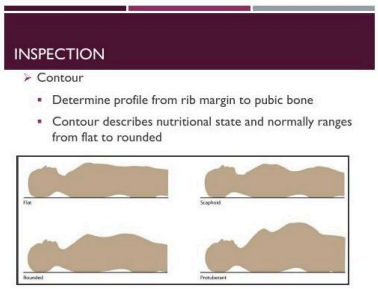
**Technique:** Order: INSPECT, AUSCULTATE, PERCUSS, PALPATE (listen before you touch!)
**Position / where you stand:** Partner supine and flat, arms at sides, knees slightly bent, bladder emptied. Drape. Stand on their RIGHT. Warm your hands and stethoscope.



Drawn diagram: the 4 quadrants (the patient's right is on YOUR left as you face them)

## Quadrant map

Draw imaginary lines through the umbilicus, one vertical and one horizontal. RUQ = liver. LUQ = stomach and spleen. Bowel sounds start in the RLQ.



Her Module 4 slides: Inspection

## 38. Abdominal contour

1.5

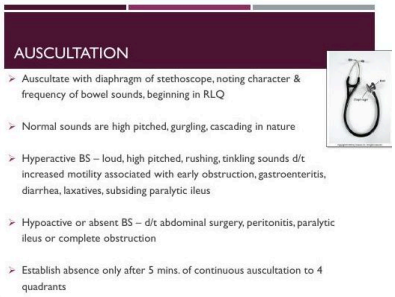
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm inspecting abdominal contour."
② **Do it (0.75):** Stand or bend at their side and look across the abdomen from the rib margin to the pubic bone.

**Say to partner:** "Lie flat with your arms at your sides."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Abdomen flat (or rounded) and symmetric. Umbilicus midline. No visible masses or pulsations."

**Common mistake:** Looking only from above.

[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 542]



Her Module 4 slides: Auscultation

## 39. Bowel Sounds

1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm auscultating bowel sounds."
② **Do it (0.75):** Put the diaphragm lightly on the skin. **Start in the RLQ**, then RUQ, LUQ, LLQ (see the diagram on the abdomen page).

**Say to partner:** "I'm going to listen to your belly. Breathe normally."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Bowel sounds active in all 4 quadrants: high-pitched, gurgling." (Absent only after 5 min of listening.)

**Common mistake:** Palpating before you listen. Starting in the wrong quadrant.

[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 545]


Jarvis p. 546 (photo)

## 40. Abdomen (general tone)

1.5

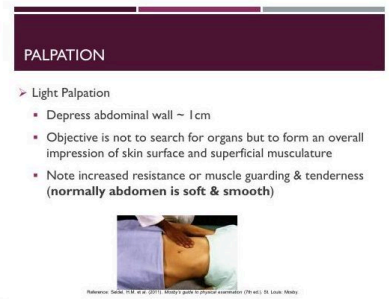
① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm percussing the abdomen for general tone."
② **Do it (0.75):** Indirect percussion: put the middle finger of your non-dominant hand flat on the skin (only that finger touching). Tap its last joint twice with the tip of your other middle finger, snapping from the wrist. Do all 4 quadrants.

**Say to partner:** "You'll feel some tapping."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Tympany predominates in all 4 quadrants."

**Common mistake:** Resting your whole hand on the abdomen, which muffles the sound. (Her slides: don't do liver span.)

[Jarvis p. 546; her Module 4 slides]



Her Module 4 slides: Light palpation

### 41. Abdomen (all 4 quadrants) 1.5

① **Name it (0.25):** "I'm performing light palpation of all 4 quadrants."

② **Do it (0.75):** Use the pads of 4 fingers together and press only about 1 cm in, with gentle circles, through all 4 quadrants. Watch their face. Do any tender spot last.

**Say to partner:** "Tell me if anything is tender. I'll be gentle."

③ **State findings (0.5):** "Abdomen soft and nontender in all 4 quadrants. No masses or guarding."

**Common mistake:** Pressing too deep (light is about 1 cm). Not watching their face.

[Her slides; doc sheet: Jarvis p. 548]

## Closing (not graded, but do it)

Help the partner sit up or get comfortable, put the bed down, place the call light within reach, thank them, wash your hands, and say: "We're all done. Here's your call light." [Jarvis p. 779]

# One-page checklist (rubric order). For every item: NAME it, DO it, STATE findings. 15 min, no prompting.

| # | Topic | Item | Pts | ✓ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Intro/Safety | Washed Hands | 0.25 | ☐ |
| | Intro/Safety | Introduced Self | 0.25 | ☐ |
| | Intro/Safety | Identified Patient with 2 Identifiers | 0.25 | ☐ |
| | Intro/Safety | Verified Allergy Status | 0.25 | ☐ |
| | Intro/Safety | Explained Assessment to Patient | 0.25 | ☐ |
| | Intro/Safety | Cleaned Stethoscope | 0.25 | ☐ |
| 1 | Mental Status | Orientation (3 assessments) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 2 | Mental Status | Culture (1 assessment) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 3 | Mental Status | Spiritual (1 assessment) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 4 | Head | Skull (size & symmetry) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 5 | Eyes | Visual Acuity | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 6 | Eyes | Pupil Size & Shape | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 7 | Eyes | Direct Light Reflex | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 8 | Eyes | Consensual Light Reflex | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 9 | Eyes | Accommodation | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 10 | Ears | External Auditory Meatus | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 11 | Ears | External Ear | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 12 | Nose | External Nose | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 13 | Nose | Patency of Nostrils | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 14 | Mouth | Lips | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 15 | Mouth | Gums | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 16 | Mouth | Teeth | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 17 | Mouth | Tongue | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 18 | Motor System | Gait | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 19 | Motor System | Grip | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 20 | Sensory System | Light Touch | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 21 | Sensory System | Pain | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 22 | Skin | Color | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 23 | Skin | Temperature | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 24 | Skin | Edema | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 25 | Skin | Moisture | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 26 | Thorax & Lungs | Chest (shape & configuration) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 27 | Thorax & Lungs | Chest (breath sounds) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 28 | Peripheral Vascular System | Carotid Pulses | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 29 | Peripheral Vascular System | Radial Pulses | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 30 | Peripheral Vascular System | Dorsalis Pedis Pulses | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 31 | Peripheral Vascular System | Posterior Tibial Pulses | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 32 | Peripheral Vascular System | Capillary Refill | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 33 | Heart | Aortic Area | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 34 | Heart | Pulmonic Area | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 35 | Heart | Erb's Point | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 36 | Heart | Tricuspid Area | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 37 | Heart | Mitral Area | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 38 | Abdomen | Abdominal contour | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 39 | Abdomen | Bowel Sounds | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 40 | Abdomen | Abdomen (general tone) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| 41 | Abdomen | Abdomen (all 4 quadrants) | 1.5 | ☐ |
| | Bonus | Pulse grading scale: 0, 1+, 2+, 3+ | +1 | ☐ |
| **Total** | | | **63** | |